IGNATIUS BOOK FAIRS

CATHOLIC IN-PERSON

PLANNING CHECKLIST

Your step-by-step guide to planning a successful in-person book fair

Initial Prep and Planning

- [ ] Using the password **ignatius**, read through and print out THE GUIDE
- [ ] Read through and print out the FAQS
- [ ] Familiarize yourself with the ADVERTISING RESOURCES
- [ ] Ensure that the space you'll be using for the fair is reserved and free of conflicting events
- [ ] Create a free account on our WEBSITE before you get busy
  - Choose **Book Fair Coordinator** as your role
  - Other roles (teachers, volunteers, etc.) can be added later
  - This makes it easy to guide others in creating their own accounts
- [ ] Invite staff, teachers, and parent/community partners to volunteer
  - Plan for 8–10 volunteers to help with planning, set-up, running, and clean-up of your fair
  - Use a free service like SIGNUPGENIUS to keep everyone organized
- [ ] Look for invitations to our 3-part workshop series and RSVP
  - Please RSVP "yes" even if you cannot attend — the recording will then be sent automatically
  - Encourage volunteers to join you
- [ ] Inside your **School Hub** (on your Ignatius Book Fairs account), update classroom names and add any additional active classrooms (use blue link "Add Classrooms" in upper right corner of the School Hub)
  - Use the **invite** feature to invite teachers
  - Resource: HOW TO INVITE TEACHERS TO THEIR CLASSROOMS
- [ ] Send an email to teachers encouraging them to look for the invitation (Step 8) and follow the prompts in this video: FEATURES FOR TEACHERS

  How to create accounts, claim classrooms, select reading recommendations for students, and build classroom wish lists
- [ ] Decide whether to host an evening shopping event for parents (and community members)
  - Begin planning the event now using SIGNUPGENIUS (or a similar service) to keep your tasks and volunteers organized

Advertising Your Fair

- [ ] Ensure the **date, times, and location** of your fair are posted on the **school or parish calendar**
  - Be as descriptive as space allows (include building name, room, and evening shopping details if applicable)

- [ ] Recruit a **dedicated volunteer** to manage fair advertising
  - This person will post regularly on **social media** (Facebook, Instagram, parish/school groups, etc.) and ensure announcements appear in newsletters, bulletins, or other community outlets (SOCIAL MEDIA GUIDELINES)

Sample Advertising Schedule

- [ ] **Parish Bulletin** – If you are connected to a parish, check the deadline for bulletin ads. Submit your ad in time so it is published directly before your fair begins. Prepare the ad early.

- [ ] **6 Weeks Out** – Post a Save the Date announcement including dates/times/location of your fair
  Resource: SAVE THE DATE GRAPHIC

- [ ] **5 Weeks Out** – Share what makes Ignatius Book Fairs special
  Resource: WHAT MAKES IGNATIUS BOOK FAIRS SPECIAL

- [ ] **4 Weeks Out** – Post details about your fair:
  - **Dates, times, and location**
  - **Accepted payment methods** (cash, check, credit card, and FACTS transactions if your school uses this system)
  - Let your community know about the opportunity to **shop online** if they cannot attend in person. You can share your organization's personal shopping link (found in the upper right corner of the School Hub, underneath your initials)

- [ ] **3 Weeks Out** – Introduce the **Family Reading Challenge**. Let everyone know they can find beautiful books for the challenge at the fair
  Resource: FAMILY READING CHALLENGE

- [ ] **15 Days Out** – Use the **parent letter template** to draft an announcement. Include dates/times of the fair and have the principal or pastor send the letter to families 1 week before the fair begins
  Resource: Edit and email THIS LETTER to your community

- [ ] **1 Week Out** – Post: "We are getting excited for our Ignatius Book Fair!" Include a fun picture of the boxes you received and let families know that a sneak peek will be coming soon!

- [ ] **Night Before Opening** – Share a photo of some featured titles on the tables. Remind your community about preview opportunities for students and shopping times for parents. You can also remind them that they can see teacher wish lists by creating an account online and connecting with your school, and then connecting their child to the classroom. A link to your school can be found in the upper right corner of the School Hub, underneath your initials.

- [ ] **Opening Day** – Share your excitement! Post a photo of children enjoying Preview Day. Remind parents that wish lists are coming home and should be returned the next morning with the chosen payment method. Checks should be made out to your organization.

- [ ] **Day Two** – Post: "Your children enjoyed the fair yesterday. We would love to see you too!" Post shopping times and your school's online shopping link for those who cannot attend in person and include more photos.

- [ ] **Day Three** – Post a thank-you graphic for shoppers so far. Remind families of the last opportunity to shop.

- [ ] **Last Day of the Fair** – Post a reminder: "Today is the last chance to shop in person!" Thank everyone who has come out, share your excitement about earning many free books for your school and classroom, and remind families that your school continues to receive rewards from all online shopping orders year-round! Encourage them to keep your school's link handy and shop anytime.

Logistics to Consider

(Within 3 Weeks of Opening)

- [ ] Print **Student Wish Lists** (enough for each child in PreK–8th grade). These will be handed out on the opening day of your fair when students stop by for their preview
  Resource: STUDENT WISH LIST
- [ ] Create **reminder labels** for PreK–3rd grade. Simple stick-on labels can be placed on uniforms at dismissal the day before your fair opens. Include fair dates, times, and location — this is the **final reminder** before the fair begins, but not the last way you'll keep families engaged.
- [ ] Prepare **starting cash/change** for sales
  Recommended: $200 in smaller bills and $30 in assorted coins
- [ ] Have a **secure cash box** (or similar solution) ready to organize cash and checks
- [ ] Order or gather **shopping bags** for customer purchases. Examples:
  - TRADITIONAL PLASTIC BAG
  - BIODEGRADABLE SHOPPING BAG
  - PAPER SHOPPING BAG EXAMPLE
- [ ] **Decor (optional)**: If you'd like to add beyond what is provided, consider balloons, twinkle lights, or streamers
  Tip: This is a good time to order or request donations for these items
- [ ] Distribute **Sneak Peek flyers** (they arrive with your shipment about 1 week before fair). Send one flyer home with each family. Extra flyers can be kept by the checkout station and given to customers. Include a letter with shopping dates and times to build excitement and remind parents.

Set-Up

(After Your Books Are Delivered)

- [ ] Locate the box marked "**Open First**"
- [ ] Plug in the **payment devices** and **external credit card readers** so they can fully charge
- [ ] Find the labeled **Marketing Kit** and place the **tablecloths** on the tables
- [ ] Locate the **5 posters** (found at the bottom of one of the marketing boxes) and hang them on the walls
- [ ] Use the **table category signs** to mark where specific categories of books will be displayed
- [ ] Set out **2–3 metal book stands** on each table
- [ ] Check the **packing slips** on the boxes to identify which category of books is inside
- [ ] Place each box in front of the table where that category will be displayed

- [ ] Log in to the **payment device** using your organization's **unique PIN** (which will be emailed to you 8 days before your fair begins)
- [ ] Use the payment device to scan the **packing slips** on the outside of the merchandise boxes. *Do not scan boxes containing set-up materials.*
- [ ] Unpack and set up the books on the tables
- [ ] Store empty boxes neatly — they will be needed for **returns after the fair ends**
- [ ] Perform a **test sale** on the payment device to ensure everything is working properly

> **If you get stuck or have questions, please contact us at 888-771-2321.**